Bhagyanathan went on to add that Sivarasan had directed him to get a photographer who could be trusted. The photographer would have to record the proceedings of the covert operation. Throughout, Bhagyanathan stressed upon his lack of knowledge of what Sivarasan's actual mission was and who his target was.

Ragothaman brought Ravi Shankar into the room, who claimed that both he and Haribabu had started sensing they were being involved in a secret LTTE operation and that both realized it was already too late to back out.

That night, Verma and Ragothaman raided a hideout where Sivarasan was apparently staying in Muthamil Nagar near Kodungaiyur and arrested Jayakumar for giving refuge to the killers of Rajiv Gandhi, which included Sivarasan. Jayakumar had visited India as early as 1984, when he had met Shanthi, an Indian Tamil who stayed in Madras, fallen in love and married her. Ever since, she was settled in Jaffna while he was serving jail time in Tamil Nadu. His sister Prema was married to Payas. Jayakumar and Payas were active during the IPKF operation in Sri Lanka. Impressed by their dedication to 'Eelam' (liberation), Pottu Amman had sent them to Madras in 1990 in disguise as 'refugees' and started setting up a base for the LTTE's INT (intelligence) group cadres. This was at a time when the Sri Lankan army was taking over the reins of battle from the IPKF. Pottu Amman could not lose his boys indiscriminately to the army's assault. He rushed hundreds of young minds from Jaffna to India to consolidate the support base being prepared by Jayakumar and Payas. But every decision of Pottu Amman's was taken in consultation with Sivarasan.

The officers continued their interrogation of the assassins. A clear picture was emerging about how mastermind Sivarasan set up the base for operation—three bases for three separate teams.

The first batch arrived on 12 September 1990. It had Perumal Vijayan, his wife Selvaluxmi and her father Bhaskaran. Bhaskaran and Selvaluxmi were Indian Tamils who had migrated to Jaffna years ago. No one but